process in Rakhine State, with the exception of Kaman voters in Thandwe, some dozen remaining Muslim voters in Maungdaw, Sittwe, and in a small number of IDP camps where electoral arrangements were made for a few voters who legally qualified as citizens. Kaman voters who were caught up in the violence of 2012 and had been displaced (for example, from Kyauk Phyu to Pauktaw or Sittwe), and had lost their ID documents, lost their right to vote. In Myebon, as a consequence of the 2014 pilot citizenship verification, around a thousand people who had accepted being called 'Bengali' and who were rewarded with citizenship regained their voting rights. However, deprived of the freedom to move, they cast their ballots secluded from other voters inside their settlement, and expressed fears about possible retaliation if their vote would stand out as different from the overall township results.[24]

Loss of union-level representation

Soon after the Rakhine State crisis in 2012, waves of violence also occurred in other parts of Myanmar, starting in Meikhtila in March 2013. Most incidents followed a similar pattern, with a small dispute between Buddhists and Muslims escalating quickly, resulting in the loss of life and the destruction of mosques and other property. The involvement of "dark forces", a "hidden power", or a "third hand" was attributed to these events, implying the instrumentation of violence against Muslims for political purposes (see ICG 2013).

Given MaBaTha's growing voice and its apparent popularity ahead of the ballot, increasingly open statements by Wirathu and others against the NLD and its leader, and some political parties' use of Buddhist-nationalist campaign rhetoric, many analysts saw the risk of another wave of anti-Muslim violence increasing with the electoral competition. With few execptions religiously motivated violence did not occur during the campaign period, and nationalist parties were surprisingly unsuccessful at union level. However, it would be short-sighted to believe that anti-Muslim sentiment, advocacy and the potential for religiously inspired violence have disappeared with the relative calm of election day, and the NLD victory (see Walton 2015).

Disenfranchisement also occurred with the candidate nomination deadline in August 2015. As a result of increased anti-Muslim sentiment, and in a break from the past, neither the USDP nor the NLD fielded a